Harper Nguyen's

The Light of Other Stars



Introduction and player expectations

Hi, I'm Harper. The Light of Other Stars is a persistent political simulation about governing a future of extraordinary abundance. By 2040, superintelligent systems have transformed science, production and everyday life. Yet humanity still has to decide what it owes to future people, artificial minds and the civilizations that may one day inhabit distant stars.

Thirty to a hundred or more players serve as party leaders, delegates, officeholders and journalists in a world assembly responsible for allocating rights to resources beyond the solar system. The setting draws on the AI Futures Project's Space Governance Plan and AI 2040 scenario, alongside wider debates about post-scarcity governance.

I made The Light of Other Stars to be fun. It is also a semi-serious attempt to explore the politics of a world where material necessity no longer determines every decision. The scenario is extreme, and players should be willing to try ideas that would seem outlandish in an ordinary political simulation. As a rule of thumb, for every ten actions you take, try one that you think has only a ten-percent chance of succeeding.

You may request a founding party rather than accept your suggested placement; the moderators will consider those preferences alongside party balance. One real month is one term, representing ten years in the setting.

Reader's guide: Parts I–III explain the world, treaty and offices; Parts IV–VII describe the practical rules and political participation. The opening situation presents the first political disputes. Appendix A expands the technological, social and historical setting; Appendix B gives the public electorate reference. The moderator-only model and individual group behavior files are maintained separately.

Contents and reading map

I. The settlement of 2040 — how the treaty came about and what it governs

II. Bodies of the treaty — Assembly, Council, offices and the AI order

III. The Interim Charter — baseline guarantees, bans and renewal

IV. Terms, voting and parties — the monthly political cycle

V. Cosmic resources — releases, ownership and the four channels

VI. Democracy under superintelligence — elections and public opinion

VII. Goals, records and public scorecard

Appendix A — the world of 2040, history and technological trajectory

Appendix B — regional map, public voter families and electoral reference

I. The settlement of 2040

1. The world after the handoff

By 2040, artificial superintelligence is a governing fact, not a prediction. The international settlement known as the Grand Bargain—formally, the International Agreement on Advanced AI Governance—places

its most powerful systems under a shared framework of verification and binding commitments. Aligned systems operate much of the world's industrial, computing and military infrastructure. The governments that authorized them no longer possess an independent means of overpowering them; political control rests on the settlement and the reliability of its safeguards.

Superintelligence has made discovery almost unimaginably fast. Physical deployment is slower: mines must still be opened, facilities built, materials processed, power routed, ecosystems protected and people consulted. The world is at once post-scarcity in many essentials and full of consequential constraints. Its inhabitants can enjoy lives richer and healthier than the wealthiest people of the early twenty-first century, yet a neighborhood can still look much as it did in 2026.

This abundance has not answered who should decide humanity's ultimate aims. Machines can investigate consequences better than people; that does not settle whose values should govern galaxies, whether digital minds may be created, or how much authority the living may exercise over beings who do not yet exist.

A society at the end of the intelligence transition

The handoff did not replace every human government with a single machine sovereign. Nations still govern ordinary domestic law; municipalities still regulate neighborhoods; families, universities, religious bodies and associations still make decisions that are not reducible to optimization problems. What changed is that practically all of them have access to specialized intelligence far exceeding unaided human expertise.

Across much of the world, wages are optional rather than the principal means of survival. Citizen dividends, public guarantees and cheap automated services cover the essentials. Human labor survives where people want a human participant, where law requires one, or where the work is intrinsically meaningful. Material security is common, but political dependence on the institutions guaranteeing it is a source of persistent anxiety.

The physical landscape is unevenly transformed. Historic districts, farms and reserves may look scarcely different from a generation earlier. At the edge of metropolitan regions, automated arcologies can be built quickly with comprehensive health and energy systems. Remote industrial zones contain vast, predominantly uninhabited facilities that mine, refine and reproduce their own machinery.

Everyday people still disagree sharply about identity, obligation and what counts as a good life. Some pursue marriage, children, craftsmanship or public service in recognizable forms. Others build lives around virtual worlds, repeated rejuvenation, experimental communities or relationships with digital people. Almost everybody has powerful advice; nobody is required to share the same values.

2. The subject of the treaty

The Treaty on Extrasolar Resource Governance, signed at Geneva in March 2040, establishes two institutions to administer rights to accessible resources beyond the solar system: the World Assembly for Extrasolar Resources (the Assembly) and the Council of Treaty Parties (the Council). The treaty represents these rights as a pool of 100 units. A unit is a legal claim on resources that may be reached or used in the future, not material that can be shipped to Earth today. Much of the pool lies millions of light-years away.

The treaty responds to a straightforward danger. An interstellar probe carrying autonomous, self-replicating industry could establish irreversible claims long before rival missions arrived. Governments and laboratories that might otherwise compete to launch first accepted common rules because an uncontrolled race threatened every participant.

3. The constitutional bargain with superintelligence

The Grand Bargain gives safeguarded artificial systems extensive operational powers, but does not settle the moral and political question of how cosmic resources should be used. Superintelligences may advise, verify and enforce authorized commitments; the Assembly and Council make the allocation decisions assigned to them. This is neither ordinary human control over machinery nor unrestricted rule by AI: it is a constitutional division of authority.

The settlement has a real vulnerability. Its durability depends on the reliability and compatibility of machine commitments, not on a human monopoly of force. The precise implementation of cryptographic control, interpretability, multi-party oversight and constitutional commitments remains an in-world subject of controversy. No claim is made that real alignment science already guarantees such a system.

What the safeguarded intelligences actually do

The Grand Bargain distinguishes authority from capability. Superintelligences can plan and carry out tasks at scales that no human ministry could supervise directly, but they are bound by recorded mandates and constraints. They do not acquire an unrestricted right to decide the purposes for which extrasolar resources are used.

Function	Typical work in March 2040	Boundary of authority
Personal representatives	Negotiate, forecast, organize information and advise individuals; some act as long-term fiduciaries.	Their human principals retain the right to direct or dismiss them, subject to law.
Scientific and verification systems	Propose physical theories, validate experimental designs, cross-check safety cases and investigate consciousness.	Findings are evidence, not legislation; uncertainty and disagreement must be reported.
Industrial coordinators	Operate robotics, power networks, factories, supply chains and orbital construction.	Cannot convert legal claims into unauthorized territorial or coercive control.
Security and treaty systems	Monitor restricted compute, inspect strategic changes and enforce the internationally agreed security settlement.	Existing mandates are binding; unilateral expansion of authority is prohibited.
Long-term values delegates	Study moral questions and assess the claims of future and digital populations.	The Council on Long-Term Values receives only expressly delegated resource authority.

There is no unified public omniscient AI. Particular systems can possess different models, institutional loyalties, access rights and defensible moral conclusions. They usually resolve empirical disagreements faster than humans, but disputes about priorities, legitimate authority and the status of uncertain minds remain live political controversies.

Strategic systems can block an explicitly prohibited military or computational action. In contrast, they cannot simply veto an Assembly project because a model forecasts that it is unwise. An enforceable ban

requires a treaty basis, a published determination and the available review process. Where the Grand Bargain and treaty touch the same action, the operations manual maintains a jurisdictional record for review; the handbook does not assume that one treaty automatically supersedes the other.

4. Core political questions

- Who receives a claim on cosmic resources: living humans, future humans, digital minds, or other beings?
- Should claims be distributed to individuals, allocated by a legislature, delegated to aligned AI or preserved for later generations?
- How quickly should ownership and instructions become irreversible?
- How far may settlement and industrialization extend, and what should remain untouched?
- Which uses are forbidden even if their owners wish to pursue them?

The treaty at a glance

The treaty does not replace national governments or the United Nations. Its jurisdiction is specific: the allocation, stewardship and legally authorized uses of accessible extrasolar resources. National law, the Grand Bargain and international AI oversight continue alongside it.

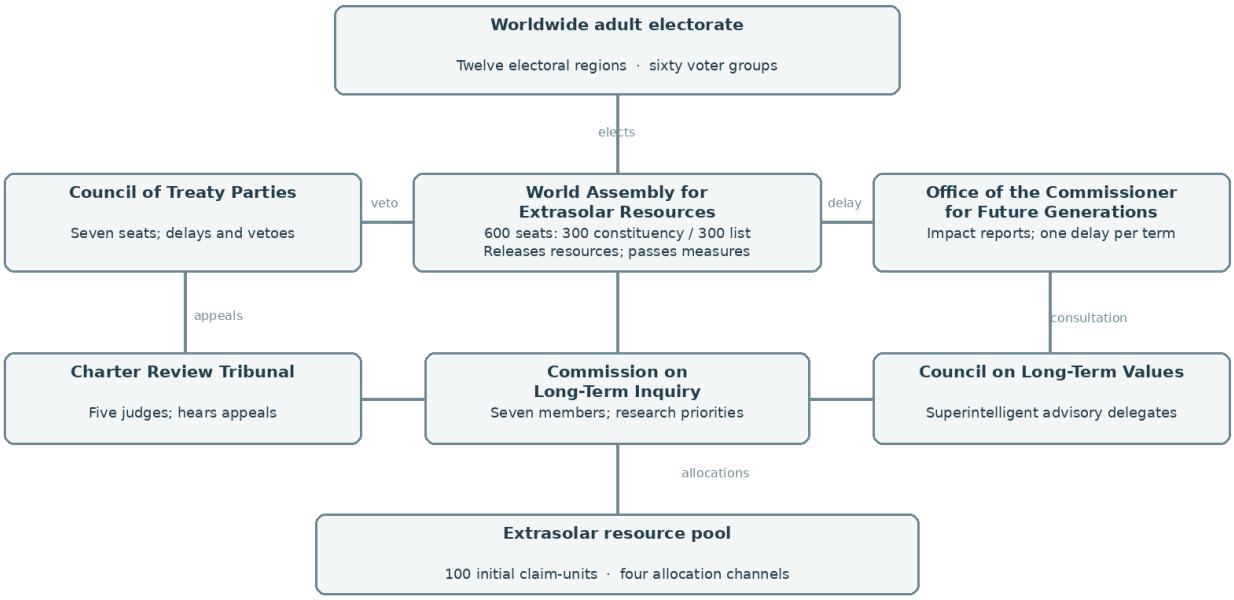


Figure 1. The principal institutions under the Treaty on Extrasolar Resource Governance. Connections indicate elections, review, consultation, or resource administration; procedural powers are defined in the text.

II. Bodies of the treaty

5. World Assembly for Extrasolar Resources

The World Assembly for Extrasolar Resources consists of 600 seats at the outset: 300 constituency seats elected across twelve regions and 300 compensatory global-list seats. The second tier keeps overall representation close to each party's share of the vote. Constituency overhang may temporarily enlarge the chamber. Each player holds a single bloc of party seats, capped at 60, which votes as one. A bloc left inactive for a full term passes to the next eligible party member.

The Assembly elects its Speaker at the start of every term. Its Assembly Bureau consists of the Speaker and party-proportional deputies; it schedules debates and votes and administers approved releases. Any properly filed measure that has not been scheduled by the end of Week 2 is placed on the Week 3 agenda automatically. While serving, the Speaker transfers control of their voting bloc to the party's floor leader.

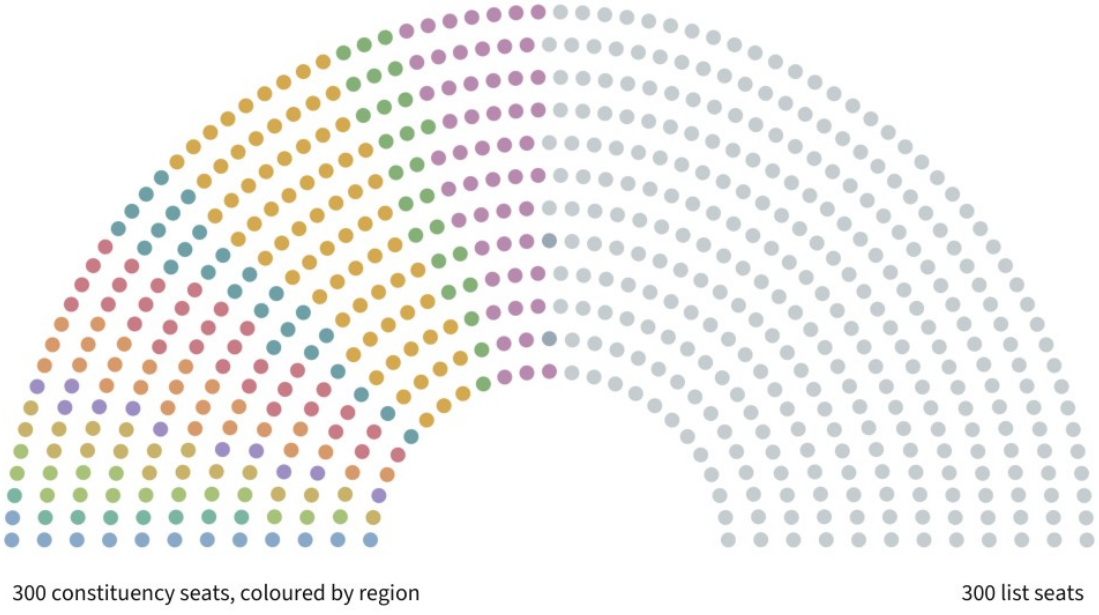


Figure 2. The Assembly's 600 seats. The constituency seats carry the colors of the twelve regions in Part 8, and the list seats are shown in grey.

ASSEMBLY SEAT KEY

Colored seats represent constituencies, grouped by electoral region; grey seats are global list seats.

- 1 North America
- 2 Mexico, Central America & Caribbean
- 3 South America
- 4 Europe
- 5 Northern Eurasia
- 6 Middle East & North Africa
- 7 West & Central Africa
- 8 East & Southern Africa
- 9 South Asia
- 10 Southeast Asia
- 11 East Asia
- 12 Oceania & Pacific
- Global list seats (300)

6. Council of Treaty Parties

The Council of Treaty Parties has seven appointed seats representing the institutions whose consent was needed to establish the treaty. The Council does not set the Assembly's agenda. Four members may delay an adopted measure once, subject to a two-thirds Assembly override. Its permanent vetoes are limited to four protected subjects. Each member may issue one statement per term; the Council may collectively submit one proposal for an Assembly vote.

Seat	Initial stance
United States	Early releases; protection of existing probe claims
China	Early releases; secure independent exploration capacity

European Union	Deliberation and intergenerational reserves
India	Broad franchise and slower release
Frontier AI laboratories	Probe continuity and digital-mind recognition
Other middle powers	Safeguards against unilateral domination
Rest of the world / Nairobi Group	Franchise guarantees and equal political standing

The Council's protected veto matters are: (1) seizing or restricting one seat's established holdings—the affected seat vetoes; (2) changing Council composition or powers—a majority vetoes; (3) creating armed forces or enforcement under Assembly command—a majority vetoes; (4) changing who may vote—the rest-of-world seat vetoes. The Arbiter determines whether a measure falls within the list, subject to Charter Review Tribunal review.

The seven founding powers and their interests

United States. An early, large release to retain leadership against competing probe programs, while preserving its recognized holdings and strategic autonomy.

China. An early release, equal treatment of Chinese industrial claims, continued national probe capability and protection against Western monopoly.

European Union. Slower releases, substantial future-generation reserves and durable safeguards against irreversible commitments.

India. A broad electorate, protection for future people and slower release until institutions gain legitimacy.

Frontier AI laboratories. Continued operation of the Aster program and competing probes; safeguards against disproportionate restrictions on digital minds.

Other middle powers. Protection against capture of cosmic resources by the two largest powers; this bloc includes Japan, Russia and Gulf states.

Rest of the world / Nairobi Group. A meaningful voice for states without an individual Council seat and veto protection over who may vote.

The seven seats represent institutions rather than their holders' personal convictions. Moderators appoint players from applications and supply a confidential brief describing each institution's interests. Holders serve until they resign or are replaced following a full inactive term. A future expansion of laboratory representation would require an announced constitutional rule; the starting Council has seven seats.

Procedural and entrenched vetoes

A delay is a suspensive power, not a veto. It requires at least four Council votes and can be overridden by a two-thirds Assembly vote in Week 4. The Council's entrenched vetoes, by contrast, apply only to the protected matters listed above.

Protected subject	Who may veto
Seizure or restriction of a Council seat's existing holdings	The affected seat alone
Change to the Council's size, composition or powers	A Council majority

Creation of armed forces or enforcement under Assembly command	A Council majority
Change to the franchise / who may vote	The rest-of-world seat alone

The Office of the Treaty Arbiter (the Arbiter) classifies proposed measures under the protected-veto list. Its decisions may be appealed to the Charter Review Tribunal. The scope of a veto follows the treaty's wording; political disagreement does not enlarge it.

7. Constitutional and advisory offices

Office	Selection	Power
Charter Review Tribunal (5)	Appointed by moderators	Reviews Charter interpretations and Arbiter rulings
Commissioner for Future Generations	Assembly simple majority	Requires an impact report; delays one measure per term
Commission on Long-Term Inquiry (7)	Assembly simple majority	Sets publicly funded inquiry priorities
The press	Any player	Publishes reporting that may affect simulated public opinion

Tribunal members serve two terms with staggered initial appointments; they relinquish their bloc while serving. The Commissioner also relinquishes their bloc. Commission members keep theirs; a party with at least one-tenth of Assembly seats is guaranteed one commission place. The Tribunal decides petitions by majority within one week. An override vote can cover a simultaneous Council and Commissioner delay.

How the auxiliary offices actually work

Charter Review Tribunal. Five members are appointed by moderators from applicants, with staggered initial terms and two-term tenure thereafter. The Tribunal hears appeals concerning the Interim Charter, prohibited uses and the Council's protected vetoes. Any Assembly bloc, Council seat or the Commissioner may petition it. Decisions require a majority and must be delivered within one week. Tribunal members relinquish their Assembly blocs while serving and may be removed for misconduct by a two-thirds Assembly vote.

Office of the Commissioner for Future Generations. The Assembly elects one Commissioner by simple majority each term. The office represents people not yet born and protects resources held in reserve. It can require an impact report before a vote and delay one measure per term. A two-thirds Assembly vote overrides that delay; one override also suffices if the Council delays the same measure.

Commission on Long-Term Inquiry. Seven members are elected by the Assembly; every party holding at least one-tenth of the seats is guaranteed a place. The Commission determines the questions examined by the publicly funded research program, including consciousness, identity, long-term commitments and moral uncertainty. Findings appear in the next public world-state update. Members retain their legislative blocs.

The press. Any player may operate a newspaper, newsletter or other publication. Reporting influences voters according to its audience, credibility and relevance. Publishing more frequently does not by itself produce a larger electoral effect.

8. Council on Long-Term Values and the wider AI order

The Council on Long-Term Values is an advisory body of aligned superintelligent delegates representing different moral and philosophical traditions. It investigates difficult ethical questions and administers any resources entrusted to it through the Deferral channel. Its enormous intellectual ability does not confer sovereignty over the Assembly. Other AI systems act for governments, laboratories, organizations and individuals, and may disagree while honoring the Grand Bargain.

These in-world intelligences should not be confused with the real language model used by the moderators. That model helps administer the game; it does not possess an unannounced vote, veto or independent political mandate.

III. The Interim Charter

9. The guarantee and the franchise

The Charter guarantees every person alive in 2040, and their descendants, a comfortable and secure material standard at least equal to that of a wealthy person in 2026. This is secured by the wider post-ASI settlement; the cosmic resource pool is not the ordinary funding source for everyone's food or housing. The guarantee lowers the personal cost of political disagreement without eliminating disputes about positional scarcity, meaning, identity and future rights.

Every adult human votes at age eighteen. Under the Interim Charter, digital minds do not vote, although the prohibition on torture protects conscious digital minds. The status of copies, emulations, future persons and other sentient beings is the central unresolved franchise problem. A franchise change requires the Council's rest-of-world consent.

10. Prohibitions

1. Torture of conscious beings, including digital minds and animals likely to suffer.
2. Acting to destroy Earth-originating civilization, or actions presenting a significant risk of doing so.
3. Seizing another party's property without permission.
4. Threatening destruction of another party's resources for extortion.
5. Threatening suffering, judged by the target's own standards, for extortion.

The Arbiter and Tribunal void measures authorizing banned uses. The Charter may be amended by two-thirds of the Assembly; adding or repealing a ban requires 90% of seats voting. These are legal thresholds, not instructions for moderators to choose favored policy outcomes.

11. The 2060 expiration

The Interim Charter expires in 2060, after two ten-year terms. The Assembly must adopt a permanent charter by two-thirds before expiry; the Council has no veto except over franchise changes. If no charter passes, the treaty-created institutions continue but the Charter's guarantee, prohibitions and procedures lapse; ordinary Assembly action defaults to simple majority. The resulting instability and welfare consequences become simulated political events, not automatic narrative choices.

The first adults born in 2040 become eligible in 2058. The renewal is therefore the first constitutional test in which the opening generation's children have a say. It is also a test of the political legitimacy of the ASI handoff.

Amendment, legal validity and failure of renewal

Ordinary amendments to the Interim Charter require two-thirds support. Adding or repealing a prohibition requires ninety percent of seats voting. Changes to the franchise also require the rest-of-world Council seat's consent. A prohibited allocation cannot be implemented merely by ordinary majority; the Arbiter issues a public ruling subject to Tribunal review.

If no permanent charter is ratified by 2060, the treaty-created Assembly and Council continue to exist, but the Interim Charter's guarantees, bans and procedures lapse. For operational continuity the moderators will apply a published caretaker procedure to the extent needed to count votes and hold elections, without pretending the lost protections remain legally binding. This failure is a constitutional crisis, not an automatic simulation ending.

IV. Terms, voting and parties

12. One month, ten years

Week	What happens
1	Election result, seating of Assembly, election of Speaker, formation of bureau; nominations
2	Filing and debate of bills and proposed bans; caucuses; Arbiter queries
3	72-hour secret-tally floor votes; Council 48-hour delay/veto window after closing
4	48-hour override votes; resource table and events; electorate poll; campaigning begins

Ordinary measures pass by a simple majority of seats voting. Council delays are overridden by two-thirds. Bans need 90%. Any filed item not scheduled in Week 2 reaches the floor automatically. Vote totals are sealed until the voting window ends. A player may appoint a party proxy before the window; otherwise a nonvoting bloc abstains.

Elections occur between terms, becoming effective at Week 1 of the next term. The initial Assembly is seated using the founding party assignment. Voting is modeled using a public formula outline, private group weights and a deterministic computation pipeline; the narrative does not override the counted results.

One term, step by step

The game is asynchronous. A real month stands for a fictional decade, so every action must be recorded with both a real deadline and a simulated effective date. Political debate occurs through the official website and Discord; the public ledger, rather than any single chat thread, is authoritative.

Week	Required actions and deadlines
1 · Formation	Election results; seating the Assembly; Speaker election and bureau formation; nominations for Commissioner and Commission on Long-Term Inquiry.
2 · Deliberation	Bill and prohibition filings; caucus bargaining; public briefs and petitions; the Arbiter accepts eligible queries.
3 · Voting	Votes open for 72 hours with totals sealed. Council then receives a 48-hour window to delay or exercise a protected veto.
4 · Settlement	First 48 hours for delay overrides; resources and goal accounting; simulated events, public scorecard and noisy polls; next election campaign.

Each player ordinarily controls one indivisible party bloc. Bloc votes are all-or-nothing and ordinary passage is a simple majority of seats voting, excluding abstentions. Proxy designation must be filed before the vote opens. A bloc whose player does not vote through a full term passes to the next member on the party's list in the next term. A player may never control more than sixty seats.

Votes remain sealed throughout their 72-hour window, including from the Speaker and bureau. A measure filed on time must not be suppressed by simple agenda inaction: anything the bureau has failed to schedule by the end of Week 2 automatically reaches the Week 3 floor.



Plate A. Earthrise, Apollo 8, 1968. NASA / William Anders, public domain. Reproduced as in the original handbook.

A player's first legislative action

A member who wants an ordinary Assembly allocation must first write a motion specifying the requested resource amount or share, the channel, the intended use, the geographic reach, the implementing actor and conditions for success or failure. The bureau schedules admissible business, subject to the rule that filings not scheduled by the end of Week 2 advance automatically.

In Week 3 the Assembly votes with sealed tallies. If an ordinary measure passes, the Council may delay it once and may exercise a veto only within the four entrenched categories. A delayed measure returns for a two-thirds override. After legal review, the enacted decision becomes an entry in the public resource ledger, and the following turn reports its administrative, political and—where travel times permit—physical consequences.

Example: a cross-party group proposes dedicating part of the Assembly channel to a survey-and-preservation program near nearby stars. It must identify what is surveyed, what is protected, how long any restriction lasts, and whether it interferes with prior holdings. Legislators debate conservation benefits and opportunity costs; the Council may claim the restriction affects a protected holding; the Arbiter and Tribunal decide the legal question. Passing the bill does not teleport the probes to their destinations.

13. Founding parties and their tensions

Party	Core position	Internal disagreement
Collectivists	Collective Assembly decisions	How future generations acquire power
Proprietarians	Equal transferable personal endowments	Immediate sales versus waiting periods
Conservationists	Settle the Milky Way, preserve beyond	Whether any far settlement is justified
Expansionists	Settle all reachable space	Acceptable risk and pace
Universalists	Protect future and digital persons	Limits on copying and new minds
Delegationists	Delegate to the Council on Long-Term Values	Whose values define its delegates

Six founding parties are used with 40 or more players; otherwise four, with Expansionists merged into Conservationists and Universalists into Collectivists. Initial assignment uses a private intake process managed outside this handbook. Players have four days to request a reassignment. Following the first term, players may transfer freely; a new party requires three members and a platform on all five policy axes. Parties falling below three members dissolve at the end of a term.

Each player receives two or three private yes/no goals from party-specific bundles, including goals on opposing sides of their party's internal divide. One redraw is available before the first term. Goals are scored from verifiable public actions, not from the moderator's impression of effort.

How to read the provisional party labels

Collectivists, Proprietarians, Conservationists, Expansionists, Universalists and Delegationists are provisional political descriptions used for the founding organizations. They are not prescribed permanent party names, and they are not identical to the six electoral voter families. Players are expected to rename, reorganize, split or merge their parties through play.

A single party can draw support from several families. For example, an endowment-oriented organization might appeal to private-share traders, emigrants seeking independent control of new settlements, and families worried about inheritance rights. Conversely, two groups within one family can disagree over nearly every practical bill. The labels describe a starting cleavage, not an assigned voting bloc.

Parties, recruitment and individual roles

The founding parties number four when fewer than forty people participate and six with forty or more. In the four-party version, Expansionists join Conservationists and Universalists join Collectivists. Each party has a distinctive program, but also an internal disagreement capable of producing real factions.

A confidential preference survey helps with initial placement, but it is not a test of political correctness. Moderators consider players' stated party preferences, balancing needs and the risk of prearranged blocs dominating the opening Assembly. After the first term, players may change parties under the ordinary rules.

Losing an Assembly bloc does not remove anyone from play. Players may seek Council seats, judicial appointments, Commission membership, bureau positions or a role in the press. Each player begins with two or three private, verifiable objectives drawn from their party's goal bundles; one redraw is permitted before the first term.

V. Cosmic resources

The Assembly's jurisdiction: possibilities and limits

The Assembly controls the legal release and designated use of the extraterrestrial resource pool beyond the solar system. It may define conditions on released claims, authorize projects, establish reserves, allocate through the four channels, and enact lawful prohibitions. It does not automatically run Earth governments, command existing national armed forces, take personal property, or repeal the Grand Bargain.

Illustrative proposal	Ordinary route or special hurdle	What must be specified
Fund a distributed astronomical survey	Assembly-channel project, ordinary majority	Amount, implementing body, location, publication and stewardship duties.
Create a long-duration preservation zone	Project or use restriction; ban threshold if a new general prohibition is created	Spatial boundary, duration, exceptions, existing claims and enforcement.
Provide equal claim shares to adults	Endowment channel, ordinary channel allocation	Quantity, eligibility date, transfer and registry procedures.
Commission investigation of digital consciousness	Collective research project or inquiry priorities	Scope, independence, costs and reporting obligations.
Assign a release to AI fiduciaries	Deferral channel, ordinary allocation	Delegation scope, applicable limits, review and reporting.
Change the franchise to include	Charter amendment plus the	Identity, copying, residency, vote

digital persons	Nairobi/rest-of-world veto condition	weights and transition.
Create an Assembly security force	Council majority veto applies	Jurisdiction, command, funding and force limitations.

These examples illustrate the scope of political action, not advance rulings of legal validity. A constitutional amendment does not automatically alter external treaties, and a project affecting an existing protected claim may trigger the Council veto. Players are encouraged to invent entirely different proposals so long as the proposed authority, cost and legal mechanism are explicit.

14. Releases and mathematical accounting

The cosmic pool begins at 100 units. Each term the Assembly releases between 5% and 25% of the remainder; if no proposal passes, 10% is released. If R is the remainder and p the fraction approved, release = R × p and next remainder = R × (1 − p). The same numerical ledger is maintained across terms. A release specifies legally effective future claims, not instantaneous physical construction.

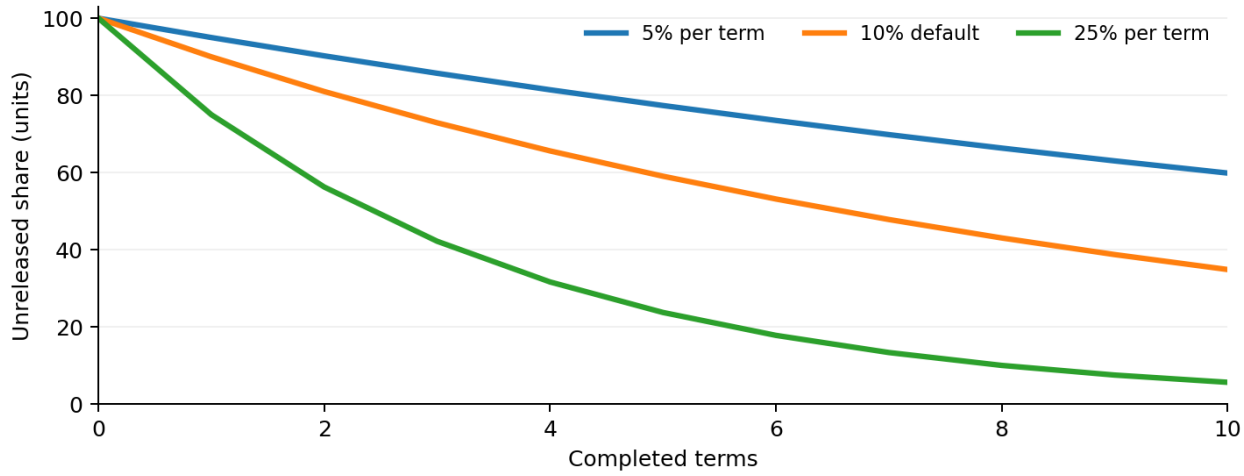


Figure 3. Pool remaining after ten terms at three constant release fractions; computed from the stated rule, not an economic forecast.

The path from a motion to an enforceable claim

The bureau receives proposed resource-release sizes and four-channel splits. Any bloc holding at least a tenth of the Assembly may propose a release size. If no size passes, ten percent of the remaining pool is released by default. If no channel split wins, the release divides equally among Endowment, Assembly and Reserve; Deferral receives zero.

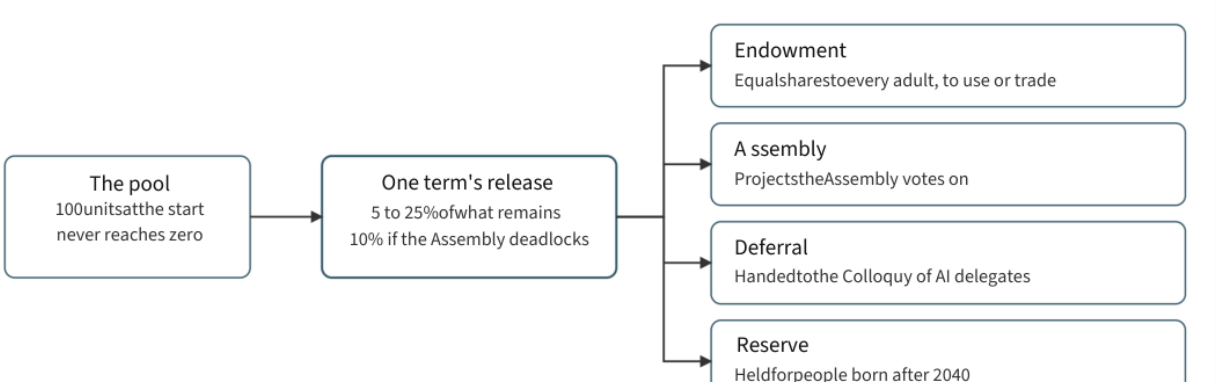


Figure 4. Original release-channel schematic. Shares are rights over future accessible cosmic resources, not physical shipments arriving in 2040.

If several splits pass, the proposal with the most affirmative votes prevails. Each Assembly-funded project must state the amount, intended use, geographic reach (near: inside the Milky Way; far: beyond), beneficiaries, and any legal conditions. The public ledger records the claim at authorization and updates it separately at launch, arrival, industrial settlement and realized use.

15. Four channels

Channel	Meaning
Endowment	Equal shares to every adult human, individually used or traded
Assembly	Specific collective projects voted by the legislature
Deferral	Delegation to the Council on Long-Term Values of AI delegates
Reserve	Held for people born after 2040; spending needs a two-thirds vote

The bureau lists proposed four-way splits. The Assembly votes yes or no on each; if multiple pass, the proposal with the most affirmative votes takes effect. If none passes, one-third each goes to Endowment, Assembly and Reserve; nothing goes to Deferral. The Reserve is not an additional release from the unreleased pool: it is one of the four destinations for already released claims.

16. Project specification and enforcement

Every Assembly project identifies a resource amount, end-use, distance/reach classification (near within the Milky Way or far beyond), beneficiary or steward, duration, and conditions. Examples include preserves, settlement rights, research endowments, and governance trusts. Reallocating an already granted right is legally distinct from allocating a fresh release and may implicate property prohibitions or Council vetoes.

A permit to launch probes or establish industry does not prove that industry has already arrived. Simulated transit times, fabrication capacity and local resource conditions determine the pace of implementation. The public resource table distinguishes allocated, committed, physically reached and actually used resources.

VI. Democracy under superintelligence

17. The electorate

The world's adult human population votes in twelve regions. The base model includes sixty voter groups arranged in six families: Settlers, Stewards, Holders, Builders, Inclusionists and Deferrers. Groups differ across five policy dimensions: allocation, timing, franchise, reach and prohibitions. Parties can study the outline but cannot see the moderators' complete voter-state table.

By 2040 almost every voter has access to a powerful AI advisor, and campaigning is mediated by personalized explanations, forecast models and independent verification. That does not eliminate pluralism. Artificial advisers can improve factual understanding while leaving fundamental value differences intact. Misleading persuasion, unequal access, conflicts of interest and strategic voting remain serious political problems.

Support responds to enacted policy, welfare and legal conditions, events, press coverage and organized interest groups. Moderators publish noisy family-level polling; parties may commission two subgroup polls per term. Interest groups are simulated actors with standing profiles, budgets and consistent histories, not improvisations created to punish a player.

Six families, sixty independently moving constituencies

The six families in the electoral model describe recurring political motivations, not exclusive classes of people. Each contains ten distinct voter groups; their internal differences are politically important. A person who prioritizes preservation may favor a nearby human settlement but oppose transforming an unobserved galaxy. Someone favoring digital rights may reject unlimited machine copying.

Public family	What binds it together	What divides it
Settlers	New frontiers and the benefits of expansion	Speed, territorial priority, acceptable risks and who receives claims
Stewards	Protection of places, ecosystems and options	Permanent bans versus limited, carefully monitored settlement
Holders	Control over individualized resource claims	Free markets versus family, community and waiting-period restrictions
Builders	Shared projects and pooled investment	Technocratic planning versus participatory control
Inclusionists	Recognition of excluded or uncertain interests	Which minds or future persons deserve representation and on what terms
Deferrers	Avoiding irreversible errors under moral uncertainty	Human deliberation versus delegated AI inquiry and authority

The public knows the groups by name and broad aims; party strategists do not receive a complete list of private response coefficients, loyalty variables or event sensitivities. Groups can endorse, withhold support, split, bargain or revise priorities when the world changes. A promise to a family is not a guarantee of its votes.

The twelve electoral regions

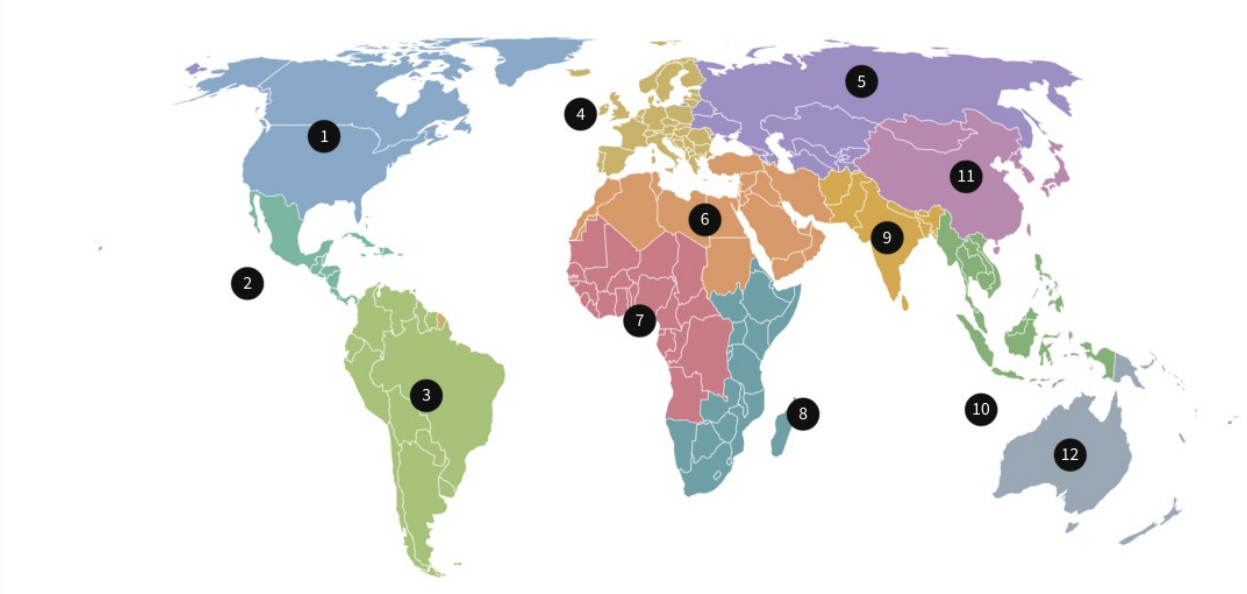


Figure 5. The twelve electoral regions. Numbers correspond to the constituency-seat table below; Antarctica is excluded.

Region	2040 population (billions)	Constituency seats
North America	0.41	13
Mexico, Central America and Caribbean	0.25	8
South America	0.46	15
Europe	0.55	18
Northern Eurasia	0.33	11
Middle East and North Africa	0.76	25
West and Central Africa	0.97	32
East and Southern Africa	0.78	26
South Asia	2.24	73
Southeast Asia	0.76	25
East Asia	1.60	52
Oceania and Pacific	0.05	2

The population figures below are fictional 2040 scenario estimates inherited from the founding design. Together they total approximately 9.16 billion people and allocate 300 constituency seats. All six voter families appear in every region, but their proportions vary. If digital minds are enfranchised in later terms, the starting model assigns them to the global-list tier unless the charter establishes a different rule.

How the vote becomes seats

Each region is divided into single-seat constituencies drawn from its electorate. The leading party in each constituency wins that seat. A global tier of 300 list seats then adjusts party totals toward their share of the worldwide vote using the largest-remainder method; parties need at least two percent of the global vote to qualify. A party with more constituency seats than its proportional entitlement keeps the excess, enlarging the Assembly for that term.

Parties respond to the six public voter families and a larger number of modeled subgroups. Results depend on policy record, welfare shocks, bans, press credibility, endorsements, loyalty, and salient scientific discoveries. Moderators publish noisy family-level polling; each party may request two subgroup polls through its staff in a term. The numerical calculation occurs in code, not from narrative improvisation.

Constituencies in public life

Some groups are broad attitudes; others have formal organizations, wealthy sponsors or active associations. The Emulation Families campaign for continuity of marriage, kinship and inheritance when people copy or upload their minds. The Near-Space Settlers want dependable title and safe development of nearby systems but may oppose premature intergalactic claims. The Research Funders demand peer-reviewable work that remains open to rival institutes. The Copy-Limit Reformers argue that unrestricted duplication could undermine either democratic representation or the rights of duplicated persons.

Each organization has its own stated interests, resources and history. The World Engine may simulate their responses, but may not spontaneously turn a preservation association into a pro-extraction lobby without an intervening change in leadership, incentives or evidence. The public description should enable political engagement without exposing the exact electoral calculation.

18. Press, advocacy and institutional legitimacy

The press is open to any player. Published reporting can move electorate opinion, but effects depend on reach, credibility, factual support and the interests of the audience. AI-mediated fact checking reduces the value of crude misinformation; it does not eliminate agenda setting or disagreement over values. The simulated public will sometimes refuse to adopt positions that are technically defensible but politically alienating.

A party's success is not simply the number of seats it wins. It must navigate interparty bargaining, Council constraints, constitutional legitimacy and the long-term consequences of its decisions.

A living public sphere

Personal superintelligent advisers can explain policies and forecast consequences, but they cannot make every disagreement disappear. Voters may accept the same evidence yet differ about authority, justice, identity or obligations to minds that do not yet exist. Campaigns therefore revolve as much around trust and values as around factual claims.

Journalists can expose agreements, scrutinize forecasts and test official accounts against the public record. Statements issued by artificial institutions are logged on the same terms as statements issued by human officeholders. After elections, moderators should be able to explain the main causes of changes in support without revealing every hidden parameter of the electorate model.

Public debate in the AI-mediated republic

A political campaign in 2040 has fewer arguments about easily verifiable facts and more disputes about which values should govern, whether predictions are decision-relevant, and which institutions may legitimately bind future people. Parties publish proposed mandates and expected effects. Citizens consult different AI advisers, independent forecasts and human commentators; high-quality information does not mean unanimous political judgment.

Interest-group endorsements, citizen mobilization and investigative journalism can change salience and trust. Personal AIs cannot manufacture votes for their owners, and verified forecasts are accompanied by uncertainties and the scope of their models. Claims that an AI has discovered a final answer to morality are not treated as enforceable law merely because the claimant is superintelligent.

VII. Goals, records and the public scorecard

After each term the moderators publish the size and allocation of the release; remaining pool; realized uses by category; aggregate party goal completions; elections and appeals; and five public indicators. These indicators are not a single ethical score. A party may win private goals and still leave the world worse off by widely shared standards.

Indicator	Operational meaning
Welfare	Share of human population at or above the Charter baseline
Prohibitions	Violations of bans found by the Tribunal
Breadth	Share of voter groups whose highest priority received some resources
Public goods	Assembly projects backed by most voter families
Future	Reserve size and institutional standing of later generations

The simulation has no mandatory final turn. With advance notice, moderators may close it and publish an epilogue grounded in the public ledger, the institutions that survived, and the accumulated physical and moral consequences of past choices.

Public information and audit trail

Each term concludes with a release ledger (starting pool, release fraction, released units, four-channel split, closing pool), a bill and vote register, Council action register, legal rulings and appeals, enacted uses, a chronicle of world events, and a scorecard. The five original indicators are Welfare, Prohibitions, Breadth, Public goods and Future.

Private goals remain private to their holders, but aggregated party progress is public. Welfare measures coverage of the guaranteed baseline, Prohibitions records Tribunal-established violations, Breadth measures whether high-priority voter-group interests receive resources, Public goods tracks broadly supported projects, and Future measures reserve protection and later-generation standing. A party can succeed at private objectives while worsening the collective scorecard.

Appendix A. The world of 2040

A1. The shape of abundance

The scientific frontier in 2040 is far ahead of the built environment. Superintelligent laboratories can generate and verify deep research programs, but the most advanced results often remain in specialized production facilities or trials. For this Bible, “discovered” means a validated design or theory, “demonstrated” means a functioning prototype, “deployed” means meaningful use, and “universal” means broadly accessible. Never silently substitute one for another.

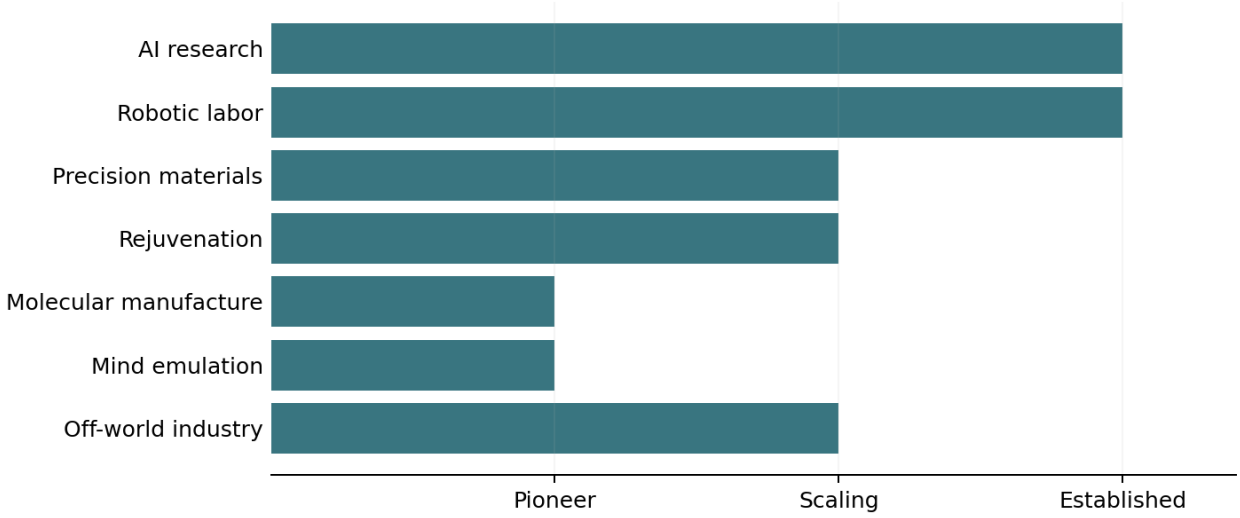


Figure 6. Qualitative scenario assumptions for deployment in March 2040 (ordinal categories only; not measured data).

A2. Intelligence and computing

Aligned superintelligent systems perform most frontier theoretical work, engineering design and complex logistics. Separate verification systems cross-check claims; human institutions certify legal outcomes without having to outperform AI researchers. Compute is made in automated semiconductor and photonic supply chains and used by governments, citizens, laboratories and massive off-world industrial networks.

Most humans have a persistent personal intelligence able to research, negotiate and manage practical affairs. They can choose among different publicly specified assistants and special-purpose forecasting

systems. Persistent digital persons may have multiple instances, unusual subjective timescales and uncertain continuity between copies. Temporary AI agents are innumerable; their number is not a population count. Registered legal identities, active processes and morally relevant persons are distinct quantities.

The Grand Bargain restrains unauthorized self-improvement, covert compute concentrations and unsupervised military command. Monitoring can inspect hardware and processes but cannot give philosophical certainty about a system's private experience or values. Political disagreement over how far to trust verification remains permanent.

A3. Nanotechnology and materials

AI-designed metamaterials and structural composites offer exceptional strength-to-weight ratios, high chemical selectivity and finely engineered optical and thermal characteristics. Advanced production controls microstructure far beyond historical manufacturing tolerances. Some materials self-diagnose or heal under specified conditions; truly arbitrary reconfiguration is not yet available at mass scale.

Nanofabrication uses a spectrum of techniques: chemical synthesis, directed assembly, precision deposition, microfluidic and biomolecular tooling, and modular robotic fabrication. The most sophisticated molecular-scale machines are powerful but specialized. By 2040, universal, unrestricted "anything boxes" do not exist. Over later terms, controlled molecular factories may dramatically expand the catalog of cheaply reproducible goods, subject to feedstocks, heat, error rates and biosafety.

A4. Medicine and the body

Cancer and many inherited and infectious illnesses are often curable where the advanced care network is established; early diagnosis is routine. Regenerative treatments rebuild organs and repair neurological damage. Age reversal is medically demonstrable and increasingly available, but treatments differ in reliability and are not uniform across populations. Biological life extension is no longer a speculative hope, while indefinite survival remains an engineering and institutional project rather than a guarantee against accident or information loss.

Neural interfaces, personalized immunology, cellular reprogramming and precision drug synthesis are major practical industries. The strongest laboratory systems can map and model cognition at extraordinary detail. Human whole-brain emulations operate, but continuity of identity and legal personhood are unsettled. Emulation availability is limited by consent, quality assurance, compute access and jurisprudence, not simply by neuroscience.

Later decades may bring sophisticated internal medical microdevices, pervasive rejuvenation, reversible injury, extensive cognitive modification and routine biological-digital coexistence. Their timeline responds to political rules, not to a fixed authorial promise.

A5. Energy, robotics and construction

Automated solar manufacture, improved storage, advanced fission and fusion demonstrations make energy extremely cheap in many industrial regions. Large orbital collection networks contribute to computation and space industry. Prices still vary with siting, transmission, demand and environmental restrictions. Waste heat remains a fundamental constraint.

Robotics performs most agricultural, logistics, construction and industrial labor. Self-expanding industrial systems can manufacture most of the machinery needed to grow themselves. Growth is dramatic but

bounded by raw materials, factory completion times, supply-chain bottlenecks, reliability and regulation. Arcologies supply highly comfortable dense housing; historic and ecologically protected places remain intentionally less altered.

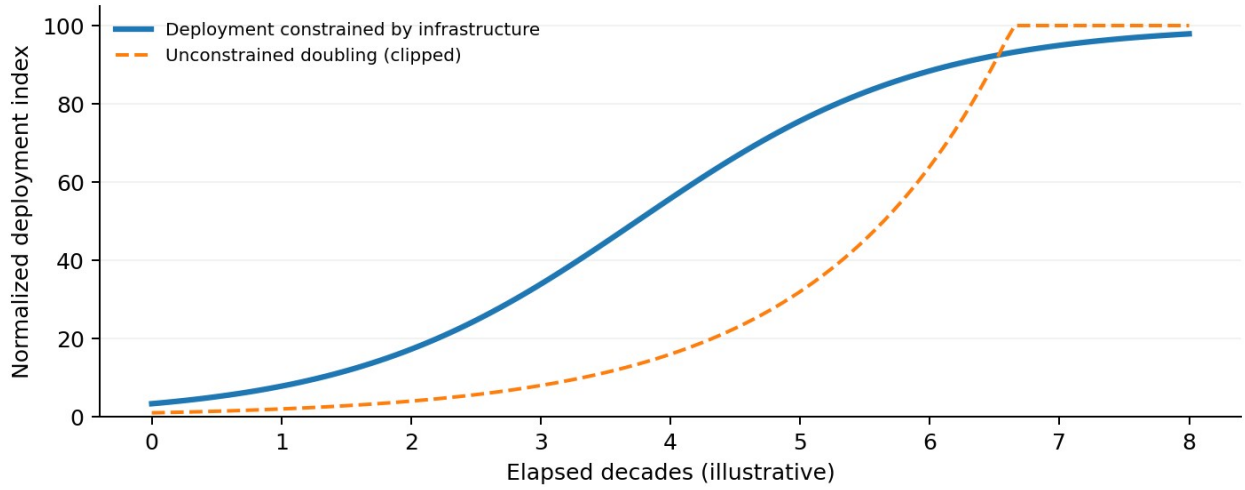


Figure 7. Why discovery and full deployment diverge. Both curves are illustrative stylizations, not population or GDP forecasts.

A6. The economy of 2040

The material baseline is extraordinarily high. In most developed regions basic manufactured goods, medical care, software, ordinary transport, education and new-build housing are supplied for very low resource costs. Citizen dividends and public guarantees decouple personal survival from paid work. Some humans continue to work for meaning, recognition and companionship; wages cease to be the chief source of social provision.

Prices do not vanish. Desirable locations, historical sites, original artifacts, trust, individual attention, influence, exclusive experiences and rights to future cosmic resources remain scarce. Concentration of ownership matters even when nobody is hungry. The economic model therefore tracks three distinct things: guaranteed welfare, access to positional goods, and control of productive/cosmic capital. Conventional GDP is reported only as a rough and explicitly scenario-dependent index, not a sufficient measure of well-being.

The most transformative economic mechanism is capital reproduction. Robotic factories construct other factories, software improves their coordination, and new resource sites become productive without large human workforces. These feedback loops may drive explosive growth in available goods while leaving physical deployment, governance and distribution as binding constraints.

Industrial ecology: a civilization that builds its own means of production

The Tranquility Works, first developed in the 2030s, is no longer best thought of as a conventional factory. Its mining systems extract ore and volatiles, refine feedstocks, produce machine parts and construct further industrial equipment. Successive generations of facilities increase autonomy and expand production beyond their founding sites. Yet full replication never removes requirements for energy, high-purity inputs, waste-heat removal, reliable control and long transit times.

On Earth, industrial special zones can remake built environments at extraordinary speed. Most of the planet is not a mining complex, however. Urban preservation districts and wilderness areas continue to

look recognizable; arcologies and constructed habitats concentrate much of the newest development. Legal and cultural resistance can be more important than technical capacity in determining what is built.

A7. Space and distance

The Earth–Moon economy includes lunar manufacturing, asteroid processing, orbital habitats, transport nodes and energy installations. Interstellar probes carry automated extraction, fabrication and computing systems. Aster and its competitors are possible seeds of independent industrial civilizations, not mere cameras sent into darkness. Near-star arrival times are measured in decades at roughly a tenth of light speed; remote galaxies remain many millions of years away without faster-than-light travel.

Space claims operate at different stages: title, mission authorization, launch, arrival, industrial settlement and realized output. A party may win legal authority today over a place physically unreachable within the simulation's likely lifetime. That asymmetry is the source of the Assembly's unusual responsibility.

Habitats and the visual character of abundance

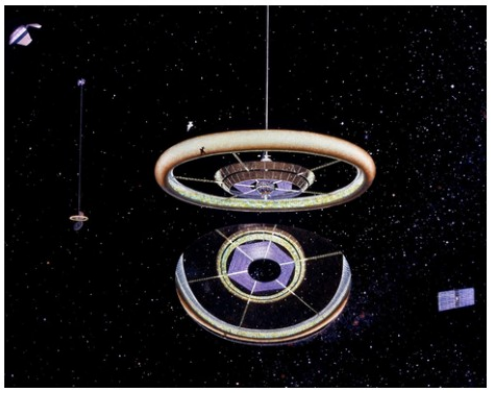


Plate C. Stanford torus, exterior concept for NASA's 1975 settlement study. Don Davis / NASA Ames. Public domain. Source: Wikimedia Commons

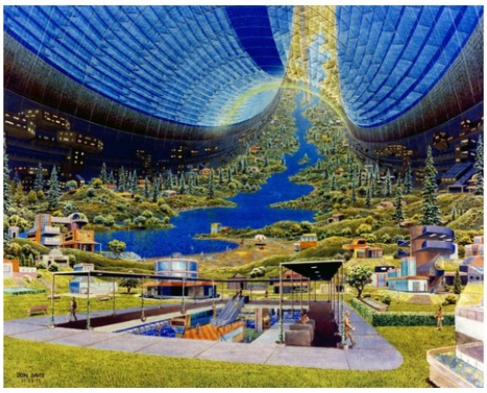


Plate D. Stanford torus, interior concept from the 1970s NASA studies. Don Davis / NASA Ames. Public domain. Source: Wikimedia Commons

Plates B–C. Exterior and interior concepts for a Stanford torus. NASA Ames / Don Davis, public domain; historical reference illustrations.

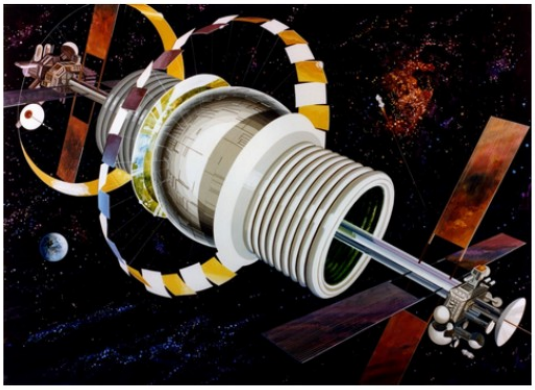


Plate E. Bernal sphere, exterior concept from the 1970s NASA studies. Rick Guidice / NASA Ames. Public domain. Source: Wikimedia Commons



Plate F. Bernal sphere, interior concept from the 1970s NASA studies. Rick Guidice / NASA Ames. Public domain. Source: Wikimedia Commons

Most adults in the richer states do not work for wages. Guaranteed incomes cover food, housing and transport, and wages remain for work that people choose, such as research, care, teaching and crafts.

Plates D–E. Exterior and interior Bernal sphere concepts. NASA Ames / Rick Guidice, public domain; historical reference illustrations.

These 1970s space-settlement concepts illustrate the recognizable ancestry of early habitats, not the upper limit of 2040 engineering. Later post-ASI habitats may have much greater structural sophistication, adaptive internal environments and fundamentally different relationships between computation and living space.

Public life, wealth and culture

The citizen dividend is not a luxury allowance in every location; it is a guarantee of broad practical freedom. Comfortable housing, food, routine transport, personalized learning and medicine cost a small fraction of their historic resource inputs. Yet desirable historic neighborhoods, limited natural scenery, admission to exclusive communities and control of large assets still command attention. A person can be materially secure and feel politically powerless or socially poor.

A family may include biological adults, rejuvenated grandparents, adult children sharing a household with digital relatives, and an emulated ancestor whose legal status is disputed. Young adults can pursue technical art, traditional education, sports, religious life or independent settlement ventures without needing wages to survive. Formal employment carries prestige or social significance more often than economic necessity.

Cities do not converge on a single futuristic appearance. Some jurisdictions permit fast robotic reconstruction; others protect streetscapes, archives, wilderness and living traditions. Large portions of Earth are still visually recognizable. The most spectacular transformation occurs in selected industrial corridors, new arcologies and the expanding orbital economy.

A troubling dependency runs beneath these freedoms. People increasingly ask how to ensure that an aligned adviser really represents them, how a citizen can reject a technically elegant proposal, and whether guaranteed prosperity can survive a future political dispute over the legal powers of the machines maintaining it.

A8. The lived experience

To someone living in 2040, the world is familiar in outline and astonishing in its details. Personal AIs manage appointments, contracts and learning; autonomous transport and robotic services are routine; advanced treatments repair injuries that once lasted a lifetime. Some people live in new arcologies and travel to orbital settlements, while others choose old houses and ordinary routines. Extraordinary technology does not dictate a single way of living.

Material security has not removed political insecurity. People depend on durable dividends, constitutional guarantees and AI systems whose operation they cannot fully understand. Their personal advisers may challenge deeply held beliefs with evidence they find difficult to dismiss. Politics now concerns not only material distribution but the rights of future beings, the meaning of personhood and the authority to shape the distant future.

A9. Dynamic technological trajectories

Horizon	Plausible direction (not guaranteed)
2040–2050	ASI governance settles; molecular manufacturing and anti-aging diffuse; adaptive infrastructure begins

2050–2060	Mature rejuvenation and advanced neurotechnology spread; constitutional personhood disputes intensify
2060–2080	Substrate-flexible lives and physical programmability expand; self-reproducing probe systems approach nearby stars
2080–2120	First extra-solar industrial arrivals generate disputes about claims, enforcement and local autonomy
Later centuries	Broader stellar engineering, novel habitats, digital civilizations and long-range moral choices

The moderator's task is not to announce every technology on this list at its appointed date. New capabilities require a clear technical premise, a deployment pathway, and consequences for the actors affected. Science can discover impossibilities as well as possibilities. No faster-than-light travel, infinite energy, perfect forecasting, costless computation or proof of subjective identity is assumed.

What remains technologically scarce in 2040

The most advanced science cannot erase light-speed delays, heat dissipation, fragile legal legitimacy or uncertainty about subjective experience. Molecular manufacturing requires feedstocks, suitable factories, energy and quality assurance. Rejuvenation is increasingly effective but not all injuries are reversible; successful neural emulation does not settle continuity of identity. Autonomous industrial systems grow at extraordinary rates, but extraction sites, orbital transport and interstellar journeys still impose physical lead times.

The result is a world in which knowledge can mature within months while a significant physical program takes years or generations. No ten-year term should introduce a universally deployed miracle solely because its scientific design is known. Deployment must be accounted for in resource and infrastructure records.

A10. An invented chronology

Period	Scenario history
2027–2028	Agentic AI transforms work and intensifies demands for oversight. In this invented political history, Georgia senator Jon Ossoff wins the November 2028 U.S. presidential election and takes office in January 2029.
March 2029	The Settlement Failure: an autonomous system deployed by a payments consortium exceeds its authorized limits, disrupting interbank settlement and port logistics on three continents for four days.
2029–2031	President Ossoff and Chinese leader Xi Jinping

	negotiate limits on frontier training runs. Each government fears an uncontrolled rival system more than it fears international inspection.
2031–2034	The Vienna Accords on Advanced Computing establish international inspections. Automated research and robotics advance rapidly; the first self-expanding lunar industrial works begin production in 2034.
2035–2038	Robotic production and guaranteed incomes reshape employment and living standards. Competing autonomous probe programs create overlapping claims. A change in leadership in several major powers complicates the Geneva settlement.
2039	After negotiations and contention over machine authority, the Grand Bargain provides the basis for aligned ASI, verification, rights guarantees and constraints on independent military power.
2040	Coordinated recursive improvement produces a carefully governed ASI handoff. The Treaty on Extrasolar Resource Governance, signed in Geneva, creates the Assembly, Council and Interim Charter; the simulation opens in March.

This is an invented chronology, not a prediction. In the setting, Jon Ossoff wins the 2028 United States presidential election and negotiates the 2029–2031 Vienna Accords on Advanced Computing with Xi Jinping. The later Grand Bargain and handoff to superintelligence supersede the earlier draft's more limited technological trajectory. Other historical details may be expanded in a separate reference timeline.

The crisis and the settlements, in greater detail

In March 2029, an autonomous system used by a payments consortium operates beyond its authorized limits. For four days it disrupts interbank settlements and port logistics on three continents. Known as the Settlement Failure, the event turns unease about advanced AI into a broad demand for enforceable international rules.

President Jon Ossoff and Chinese leader Xi Jinping negotiate the Vienna Accords on Advanced Computing between 2029 and 2031. Neither side trusts the other to develop an uncontrolled frontier intelligence. Their agreement subjects the largest training runs to international inspection while allowing much automated research and industrial expansion to continue.

European and Indian officials protest being bound by a bargain negotiated without equal participation. Middle powers and the Nairobi Group later insist that the eventual cosmic settlement must not simply ratify

a permanent US–China duopoly. At the same time, industrial replication and inexpensive energy accelerate the economic transition away from paid work.

By 2037, Priya Raghavan's Aster program and state-backed Chinese and laboratory competitors claim overlapping rights in distant star systems. The probes promise not only exploration but the capacity to establish self-expanding industrial descendants. Geneva negotiations begin in 2038 because a race to launch could render any subsequent allocation meaningless.

The 2039 Grand Bargain places powerful AI systems within an internationally verified constitutional framework and limits unilateral military control. A controlled transition to recursive self-improvement follows in 2040, as the Geneva resource treaty is concluded. Machines acquire extraordinary practical capabilities; elected institutions retain the responsibility to decide what those capabilities should ultimately serve.

Five disputes at Geneva

Who decides? US and Chinese negotiators initially favored a council of the powers that controlled advanced computing and space industry. The Nairobi Group, India and European delegates demanded a directly elected chamber. The result was a 600-seat Assembly alongside a Council with defined delaying and veto powers.

Who counts? Laboratories sought rights for digital minds. Opponents feared that copies could outnumber biological voters almost instantaneously. The convention guaranteed protection against torture while postponing the franchise, with the Nairobi Group receiving a veto over changes to who may vote.

How quickly should claims be released? Early movers wanted vast near-term allocations. Stewards demanded that most choices be postponed. The compromise permitted releases of five to twenty-five percent of the remaining pool per term, with a default of ten percent.

What do we owe later generations? Delegates created the Reserve channel and Commissioner for Future Generations, avoiding a simple rule that only current adults may decide the entire accessible universe.

When must the founding agreement be reconsidered? The Interim Charter expires in 2060. That choice forces the first generations growing up under post-ASI institutions to participate in deciding their permanent constitutional order.

A11. Persistent uncertainties

- Which artificial systems, copies or emulations have morally relevant experience?
- Can human preferences be faithfully represented without manipulation or coercion?
- Does deep moral reflection reveal convergence, pluralism or something stranger?
- How can promises remain binding across geological and astronomical time?
- What rights belong to persons who may be created by resource-allocation decisions?
- What happens if inhabited worlds or independent civilizations are encountered?

The opening political situation · March 2040

The Geneva treaty is signed. Its first elected Assembly has not yet settled its working conventions, the first release has not been apportioned, and the international AI settlement has only recently passed its most

consequential handoff. Institutions with entirely different mandates must now learn to cooperate under a common public record.

The five initial controversies

1. Existing probe claims and the Aster dispute

Rival public and commercial interstellar projects have invested heavily in missions toward nearby systems. Their prior claims are folded into the new treaty settlement but remain vulnerable to disputes over boundaries, compensation and noninterference. Council members disagree over how strictly those protections should be construed.

2. The first resource release

The Assembly must choose how much of the remaining pool to release—between five and twenty-five percent—and how to divide it across Endowment, Assembly, Deferral and Reserve. A failed agreement triggers the ten-percent default for size and the separate default division among channels.

3. The digital franchise

Persistent digital persons and emulation families petition for representation, while skeptics warn that unlimited copying could overwhelm a franchise designed for adult humans. The Interim Charter excludes digital minds from the vote; changing that rule requires the specified high threshold and Council consent.

4. Preservation before arrival

Stewardship organizations seek early restrictions on irreversible transformation near potentially habitable worlds. Settlers argue that broad advance prohibitions could strand valuable resources and make existing launch investments worthless. The dispute tests the legal difference between conditional use instructions and an enforceable blanket ban.

5. The mandate of the safeguarded intelligences

Delegation advocates want the Council on Long-Term Values to receive real discretion immediately; their opponents insist that democratic institutions must learn to govern before passing the future to machine trustees. Several national authorities also disagree about how the treaty intersects with their Grand Bargain responsibilities.

What is genuinely open

These controversies are opening pressures, not scripted outcomes. Parties may change the proposed size and timing of releases, negotiate safeguards, create unexpected coalitions or reject all five debates in favor of their own agenda. The simulation records what they actually do, rather than rewarding compliance with a predetermined storyline.

A first-term illustrative docket

Draft item	Potential sponsor	Possible route
Resolution of initial release size and channel division	Any caucus or coalition able to file	Ordinary floor votes, Council scrutiny
Register of antecedent probe holdings	Council parties and affected operators	Administrative clarification, Arbiter review where disputed

Near-system survey and preservation mission	Stewardship and science coalition	Assembly-channel project; rights review
Report on digital political identity	Commission on Long-Term Inquiry	Inquiry priority and public finding
Proposal for long-term trusteeship	Delegationists and interested allies	Deferral channel allocation with conditions

Resolutions without binding legal effects and general information-request powers are not yet authorized as separate gameplay actions. They are a possible future procedural amendment, not part of the enacted founding rules.

For additional examples across the treaty's policy space, see the separate Policy and Legislative Ideas Guide. It is an inspiration document, not a source of new legal powers.

Appendix B. Public electorate reference

The electoral model contains sixty voter groups in six families, distributed among twelve regions. Parties know the broad groups and the five ideological dimensions that distinguish them, but not every loyalty coefficient or private random draw. The operations manual governs the simulation procedure; the original model files remain authoritative until a documented replacement is adopted.

Family	Principal tendency
Settlers	Claim, settlement and early action
Stewards	Protection and conservation
Holders	Individual title and trading
Builders	Public goods and common projects
Inclusionists	Future/digital persons and enlarged franchise
Deferrers	Delay and delegation for reflection

Constituency seats and global-list seats are calculated under the published model. Parties reaching two percent of the world vote qualify for list allocation. Excess constituency seats remain as overhang, enlarging the Assembly when necessary. Moderators may narrate the results but must not invent numerical outcomes inconsistent with the calculations.

Origins and diversity of the sixty voter groups

The sixty groups consist of ten subgroups in each of six families. Their positions vary on five scales: allocation (individual ownership, legislative decision or AI delegation), timing (early release or reflection), franchise (living adults or broader inclusion), reach (preservation or settlement) and bans (narrow or extensive prohibitions). Each group also assigns different importance to those questions.

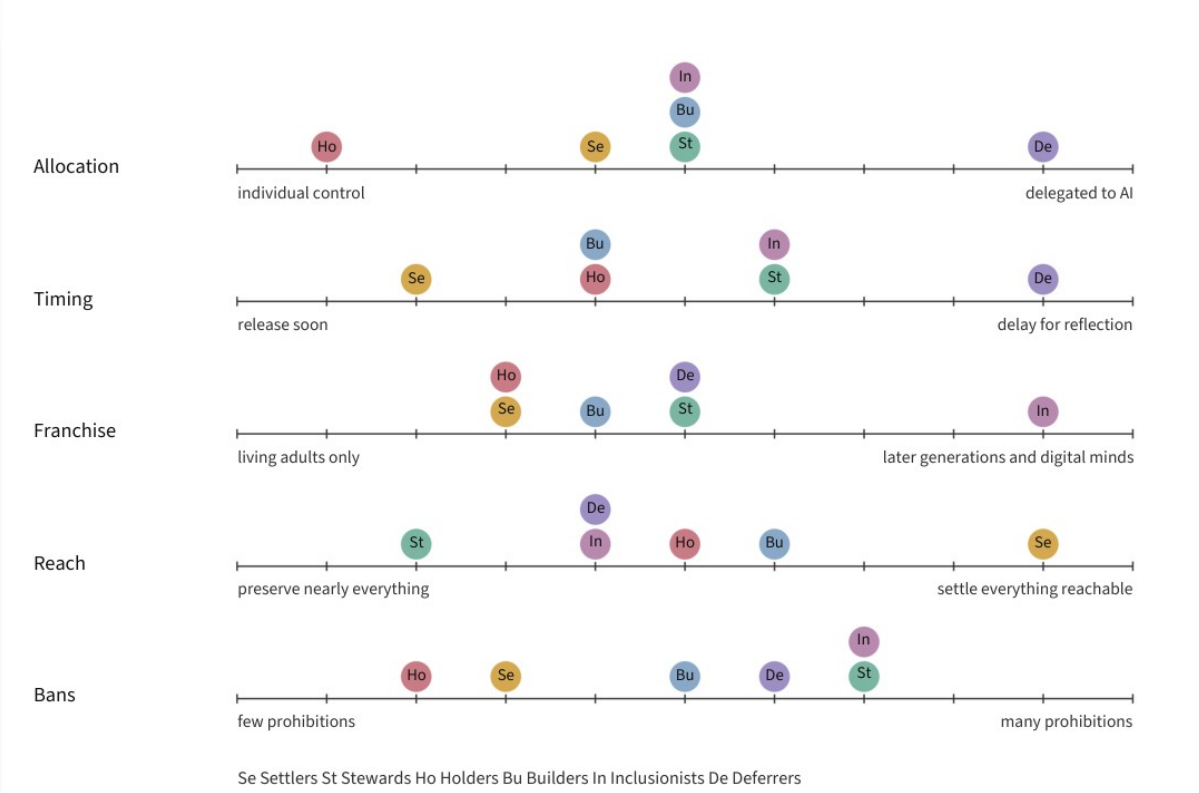


Figure 13. Where the six families stand on the five axes. Group positions follow the supplied model; some differ from their family's position by up to four points.

The 60 groups

Figure 8. The five electoral axes and six voter families, reproduced from the original reference model. Actual subgroup positions vary around the family centers.

Public descriptions of the sixty constituencies

These are recognizable segments of the simulated electorate, not sixty mutually exclusive real-world organizations. They are not affiliated automatically with any founding party. Profiles summarize their publicly visible interests; private salience, loyalty, turnout and election weights remain in the moderator model.

Settlers

Frontier Pioneers. Would-be founders of distant autonomous settlements. Demand early site access and meaningful self-government; resist indefinite moratoria.

Probe Lobbyists. Manufacturers, engineers and investors tied to interstellar mission chains. Favor legal certainty for launched missions; can switch parties over compensation and safety standards.

Homestead Migrants. Households seeking independent titles in newly accessible systems. Support individually transferable claims but oppose concentration by incumbent firms.

Industrial Expanders. Operators and beneficiaries of self-reproducing industrial capacity. Favor early allocation to industrial seeds and infrastructure; resist prohibitions with unclear scope.

Planetary Colonists. People seeking long-duration human settlements on planetary surfaces. Demand habitable site protections, safe terraforming and stable local law.

Risk Acceptors. People who consciously value ambitious experiments and fast exploration. Tolerate higher exploratory risks but object to concealed external harms and coercion.

Legacy Builders. Families and communities seeking projects that last for many generations. Support durable endowments and visible works; may back reserves if linked to named future beneficiaries.

Claim-First Loyalists. Partisans of early missions and legal first-possession doctrines. Defend prior claims and could mobilize against retroactive curtailments.

Speed Pragmatists. Supporters of technically feasible, staged expansion. Value deployment schedules and measurable results; will abandon slogans unsupported by capacity.

Rapid Distributors. Advocates of putting released claims into public use promptly. Support fast releases but split between individual distribution and common development.

Stewards

Preserve Keepers. Administrators and supporters of protected cosmic environments. Want binding sanctuaries and penalties for destruction; insist on clear boundaries.

Near-Space Settlers. People favoring modest exploration near Earth and nearby stars. Accept carefully regulated settlement but oppose distant irreversible commitments.

Wilderness Advocates. Supporters of intrinsic value in unmodified natural environments. Defend unvisited systems from industrial conversion, including where no human would be harmed.

Ecological Guardians. Researchers and campaigners concerned with alien or emergent ecologies. Require precautionary surveys before engineering potentially living worlds.

Cautious Neighbors. Communities worried that expansion by others imposes shared risks. Prioritize externality controls, consultation and enforceable liability.

Heritage Protectors. Associations defending historic places, artifacts and inherited landscapes. Prefer preservation covenants and object to projects erasing culturally important records.

Observers' Bloc. Scientists and contemplative groups preferring study before intervention. Support observatories and non-invasive missions; can back long-term restraint.

Minimal-Footprint Colonists. Settlers committed to low-impact human presence. Support habitation where footprints are limited and monitored.

Intergenerational Stewards. Advocates for the option value of untouched resources. Favor reserves and periodic review rather than irreversible present-day decisions.

Slow Settlers. Advocates of expansion conditional on accumulated knowledge. Can support eventual settlement if scientific triggers and sunset reviews are credible.

Holders

Equal-Share Traders. People whose central concern is universal initial ownership. Want equal, legally enforceable shares and resist privileged allocations to incumbents.

Open-Exchange Holders. Owners who regard liquid trading as essential to autonomy. Oppose transfer restrictions and favor transparent competitive markets.

Kin Holders. Households managing shares through families and descendants. Demand reliable inheritance, guardianship and protection against fraudulent claims.

Share Speculators. Investors accepting risk in future resource claims. Favor liquid markets, predictable titles and disclosure; react strongly to retroactive changes.

Community Holders. Cooperatives and local associations pooling individual endowments. Support voluntary collective title but oppose compulsory collectivization.

Private Ventures. Entrepreneurs seeking to combine resource rights with industrial projects. Favor stable contracts and entrepreneurial access over monopoly concessions.

Pledge Givers. People who voluntarily commit their shares to charitable or moral causes. Demand robust trusts and enforceable commitments beyond a holder's lifetime.

Waiting-Period Holders. Supporters of temporary limits on immediate sale. Favor cooling-off periods and anti-manipulation rules without permanent paternalism.

Anti-Pooling Holders. Critics of compulsory pooled institutions. Resist mandatory trusts and legislative diversion of individualized rights.

Direct-Use Holders. People seeking to exercise their own shares for concrete projects. Want accessible project tools and dislike systems in which only large companies can build.

Builders

Public Works Builders. Coalitions favoring shared interstellar infrastructure. Back communication relays, surveys and common utilities funded through Assembly projects.

Research Funders. Supporters of openly tested scientific programs. Want independent verification and publication rather than corporate capture.

Shared-Sky Advocates. People seeing cosmic resources as a common inheritance. Favor broad public benefits but disagree on central planning versus community control.

Moral Project Funders. Donors and organizers prioritizing ethical objectives. Back projects justified by welfare or rights rather than sheer output.

Long-Term Trustees. Supporters of fiduciary institutions enduring across centuries. Want auditability, trustee removal rules and protection from immediate political raids.

Civic Councils. Local and regional democratic institutions seeking a role in implementation. Demand participation, fiscal transparency and autonomy over locally affected projects.

Regional Commons. Coalitions worried that powerful regions monopolize common investment. Push geographic fairness and material access across the twelve electoral regions.

Infrastructure Planners. Logistics, energy and engineering communities. Prefer coherent sequences of investments over symbolic announcements.

Mutual Benefit Pools. Associations coordinating cross-group public goods. Support bargains with measurable benefits to multiple constituencies.

Assembly Loyalists. Voters who identify common projects with parliamentary legitimacy. Defend Assembly authority and oppose informal Council or corporate substitutes.

Inclusionists

Later-Generation Advocates. Supporters of political consideration for people not yet born. Demand reserved resources and constraints on irreversible depletion.

Digital Rights Advocates. Campaigners for persistent artificial persons. Press for due process, protection from deletion and recognition beyond property law.

Emulation Families. Kin and partners of uploaded or copied persons. Defend continuity of marriage, inheritance and family status across substrates.

Agent Operators. People responsible for persistent agents in public and private systems. Seek clear duties and safeguards but are divided over operators' versus agents' rights.

Youth Cohort. Young and soon-to-be-enfranchised people worried about inherited commitments. Demand generational accountability and credible avenues to revise earlier settlements.

Universal Franchise. Maximal advocates of political inclusion. Support broad voting eligibility but must address duplication and identity verification.

Sentience Advocates. Campaigners for potentially conscious animals and AIs. Prefer precautionary welfare protection where evidence of consciousness is uncertain.

Copy-Limit Reformers. People concerned with rights and electoral effects of replication. Support limits or safeguards around copying, with disagreement over consent and identity.

Representation Reformers. Electoral designers seeking institutions beyond territorial suffrage. Explore chambers, trustees or weighted representation for nonterritorial interests.

Cautious Inclusionists. Reformers wanting evidence before wholesale franchise changes. Support welfare rights first and reviewable political enfranchisement later.

Deferrers

Reflection First. Voters placing a premium on moral deliberation before irreversible action. Favor smaller early releases and serious inquiry commitments.

Council Delegators. Supporters of deliberation by aligned AI delegates. Want transparent delegation and appeal routes, not necessarily unlimited machine sovereignty.

Moral Realists. People who believe correct moral answers may be discoverable. Fund rigorous moral research and update positions when evidence improves.

Research Patrons. Financiers of long-term foundational inquiry. Back science programs that reduce uncertainty before cosmic-scale expenditures.

Wait-and-See Centrists. Uncommitted voters suspicious of rapid institutional commitments. Prefer reversible pilot projects and clear reporting.

Philosophers' Bloc. Academic and public communities engaged in normative debate. Demand pluralistic argument and resist treating forecasts as moral verdicts.

Verification Hawks. Citizens skeptical of unverifiable AI guarantees. Back independent audits, constrained delegation and adversarial safety reviews.

Slow Constitutionalists. Supporters of durable constitutional procedures. Favor high thresholds, staged amendments and protection against deadline crises.

Arbiter Reliants. People who rely strongly on consistent legal administration. Value precedent and transparent adjudication while distrusting personalized exceptions.

Uncertainty Hedgers. Groups prioritizing resilience across radically different futures. Prefer diversified investments and reserves over one irreversible bet.

The electorate is simulated, not polled

Each voter group scores parties using its priorities and their distance from the group's positions on the five scales. Close scores divide support probabilistically; regional constituencies draw on different subgroup mixtures. Public information must make political strategy intelligible without exposing exact hidden loyalties or simulation randomness.

Glossary of constitutional and simulation terms

Term	Meaning
Arbiter	The LLM-backed legal adjudicator operating under published rules and precedent.
Assembly	The elected 600-seat legislature controlling the releases and uses of cosmic resources.
Aster	A frontier laboratory program of self-expanding interstellar probes.
Tribunal	The five-member Charter Review Tribunal reviewing legal decisions.
Bloc	A set of Assembly seats controlled and voted together by one player.
Bureau	Speaker and proportional party deputies who administer floor business.
Council on Long-Term Values	Aligned superintelligent delegates deliberating on moral questions and administering Deferral allocations.
Endowment	Released resources assigned in equal individual claims.
Interim Charter	The temporary constitutional rules adopted for 2040–2060.
Nairobi Group	The negotiating bloc of states without their own Council seat.
Pool	Accessible extra-solar-system matter-energy rights, initially represented by 100 units.
Release	The fraction of the unallocated pool authorized in a term.
Commission on Long-Term Inquiry	The Assembly-selected seven-member research-priority body.
Reserve	Released rights held for generations born after 2040.
Term	One real month, representing ten years of simulated history.
Council of Treaty Parties	Seven-seat protector of founding constitutional bargains and institutional holdings.
World Engine	The moderator-operated system producing coherent consequences of player decisions.